

MHEWS Platform — Response to Review Comments

1. Already Implemented

- Community Report is already available without login (public access).
- The Report Generator module already exists (compliance, drill, and incident report generation).
- The Dashboard is already displayed together with the Map View, not as a separate page.
- Dispatch Monitor is already automatic: dispatch records are generated the moment a CAP alert is published, with no manual step in between.
- The alert workflow is already human-in-the-loop by design: hazard layers are advisory, and an authorized analyst reviews the map before issuing an alert. No automatic threshold-based alerting exists, and none is planned, consistent with the current review notes.
- SOP Documents already support an AI-assisted summary workflow (AI-generated draft, human review, approve/reject) before publishing.
- Contact Directory already exists as the recipient list used for alert dissemination (email/WhatsApp/phone, filterable by hazard type and region).

2. Feasible — To Be Implemented

- Consolidate the four layer groups (Disaster Filters, Shelters, Wind & Current, Exposure) into a single left-panel layer control, shared identically between 2D and 3D views.
- Show layer legend/info only when the corresponding layer is active.
- Apply filter and transparency/opacity controls per layer, consistently across all layer types.
- Add file upload capability to SOP Documents (currently text-entry only).
- Surface the Warning Radius field in the CAP Warning authoring screen (the field already exists in the database but is not yet exposed in the UI). We will also clarify with the reviewer whether "Warning Radius" refers to the alert dissemination radius or the impact-analysis buffer radius, since both concepts currently exist separately.
- Extend administrative-boundary-based analysis to the district level (ADM2). District-level boundary data is already available in the system; this is a matter of connecting it to the existing impact-analysis and filtering tools rather than sourcing new data.
- Move Risk & Scenario Modeling under Impact Analyzer as an advanced, authorized-user-only mode, rather than a separate top-level menu.
- Clarify and, if needed, rename Contact Directory so its purpose (alert-dissemination recipient list) is unambiguous to reviewers.

3. Items Requiring Your Decision

We would like your guidance on the following points before proceeding, since each affects the underlying architecture and the amount of engineering work involved.

- **Deployment model.** Over the course of the project we've received guidance toward a fully global platform, then toward country-based deployments with each country hosting its own database, and now toward anonymous users being able to see all data regardless of country. These three directions are architecturally incompatible with each other — for example, a country-isolated deployment cannot simultaneously provide a single view containing every country's data. Could you confirm which single model you'd like us to build toward: (a) one global shared instance, (b) fully separate, self-hosted instances per country, or (c) one shared instance with country-based access filtering? We'll align the rest of the system to whichever is confirmed.
- **2D/3D feature parity.** The 2D and 3D map views use different underlying map libraries (the 3D library was adopted per your team's recommendation). Because of this, not every layer type or interaction can be mirrored 1:1 between the two views without a separate implementation effort for each. Could you provide a prioritized list of which specific features matter most for parity, so we can scope this realistically rather than attempting full parity across every layer at once?
- **User role model.** We've received two different directions on access control: a strict top-down hierarchy (Super Admin down to Analyst), and separately, a request that very small/local operators (e.g., a local first-responder) be able to use the platform without going through that hierarchy. These imply two different role models with different implementation scope. Could you specify whether you'd like a detailed multi-role system (Org role / Country role / Alert Maker / Report Maker / Reviewer / Analyst, etc.), or a simpler two-tier model (public/unauthenticated viewer + authenticated operator)?
- **External data ingestion limits.** For country-uploaded datasets, we're not able to build a custom adapter for every possible file format or every country's proprietary data structure, and we cannot obtain restricted government-issued API keys on a country's behalf — those would need to be provided directly by each country's data authority. We'd propose a defined set of supported formats (e.g., GeoJSON, Cloud-Optimized GeoTIFF, standard WMS/WFS endpoints) with a maximum file size per upload, and treat anything outside that scope as a separate, custom integration request with its own timeline. Could you confirm whether this scoped approach works on your side, and let us know if there are server/hosting capacity constraints we should design around for large raster/vector uploads?
- **Reference platform for map layout.** The examples provided (African Flood and Drought Monitor, AWARE, WMO/CMA-GDFS, Global Drought Observatory, Copernicus EMS, PRISM) each use a different internal layout and visual treatment — there isn't a single shared standard among them, each product has its own distinct design language. To move forward efficiently, could you identify one primary reference (or a short, prioritized list of specific interactions you'd like replicated) rather than "all of the above," so we can design a coherent, original layout rather than reconciling several different design languages at once?

- **Placement of map UI controls (zoom, basemap switcher, tilt/compass, etc.).** We noticed the reference screenshots place these controls differently from one another — zoom controls appear in different corners, the basemap switcher (light/dark/satellite) is styled and positioned differently across examples. Since there's no consistent convention across the references, could you confirm a single preferred layout for these controls so we implement one consistent placement rather than guessing per element?
- **Screen real estate / default expanded vs. collapsed state.** Combining all layer groups, legends, opacity controls, a time slider, basemap options, and the impact panel so that everything is visible at once risks leaving very little space for the map itself, and would require the user to manually collapse each panel individually to see the map clearly, particularly on standard (non-widescreen) monitors. We'd like to confirm whether you're open to a collapsible/accordion-style panel (only the active layer's controls expanded at a time, others collapsed by default), or whether you specifically require all controls visible simultaneously by default.